

▼ HEAVY CAVALRY SWORD

Date 1750

Origin UK

Weight 1.36kg (3lb)

Length 1m (3¼ft)

The single fuller (groove along the back of the blade) on this long, straight, heavy cavalry sword indicates that the blade was single-edged. While the heavy cavalry used swords such as this, the light cavalry favoured a curved blade.

Blade decorated with silver inlay

Hilt made of horn

Broad, forward-curving blade

▲ AYUDHA KATTI

Date 18th century

Origin India

Weight 1.15kg (2½lb)

Length 59.5cm (23½in)

The *ayudha katti*, or the Indian *moplah* sword, was used by the Muslims in the Malabar Coast of southwestern India. It was developed from an implement used to cut through dense undergrowth.

Blade flattened towards tip

▲ CAVALRY TROOPER'S SWORD

Date 1770–1790

Origin UK

Weight 1kg (2¼lb)

Length 82cm (32¼in)

This cavalry trooper's sword was probably manufactured for the East India Company, an English enterprise formed in 1600 for trade with Asian countries. The sword's overall length, including the hilt, is 102cm (40in).

Leaf-frond patterning in gold

◀ NIZAMS' TALWAR

Date 18th century

Origin India

Weight 1.1kg (2½lb)

Length 94.9cm (37¼in)

The blade inscription on this Indian *talwar*, or curved sword, suggests that it was made for the Nizams of Hyderabad, Muslim princes who ruled part of southern India from 1724.

Silver-covered hilt

Narrow fuller on back of blade

▲ NORTH AFRICAN SAIF

Date Late 18th century

Origin North Africa

Weight 700g (24¼oz)

Length 83.5cm (33in)

This *nimcha* or *saif* (Arabic words for sword) is of a type made in North Africa – a part of the Ottoman Empire from the 16th century – and in parts of Arabia associated with Yemen and the Hadramaut.

▼ HALF-BASKET CAVALRY SWORD

Date c.1780

Origin UK

Weight 1.1kg (2½lb)

Length 92cm (36¼in)

This half-basket cavalry sword is single-edged and marked "Gills Warranted"; the manufacturer Gills of Birmingham was a major supplier of cavalry swords in the late 1700s.